

WHO GETS INTO THE MEETING

A meeting invite is not a courtesy, it is a cost.

How to build the guest list without stealing anyone's hour.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

Every extra person in the room is an hour taken from someone who had real work waiting.

THE CASCADE

How the guest list swells.



WHAT YOU SEE

Nobody writes down what the meeting is for, so nobody knows who needs to be there...



THE MECHANISM

...to avoid leaving out anyone who looks important, the invite goes to the whole list...



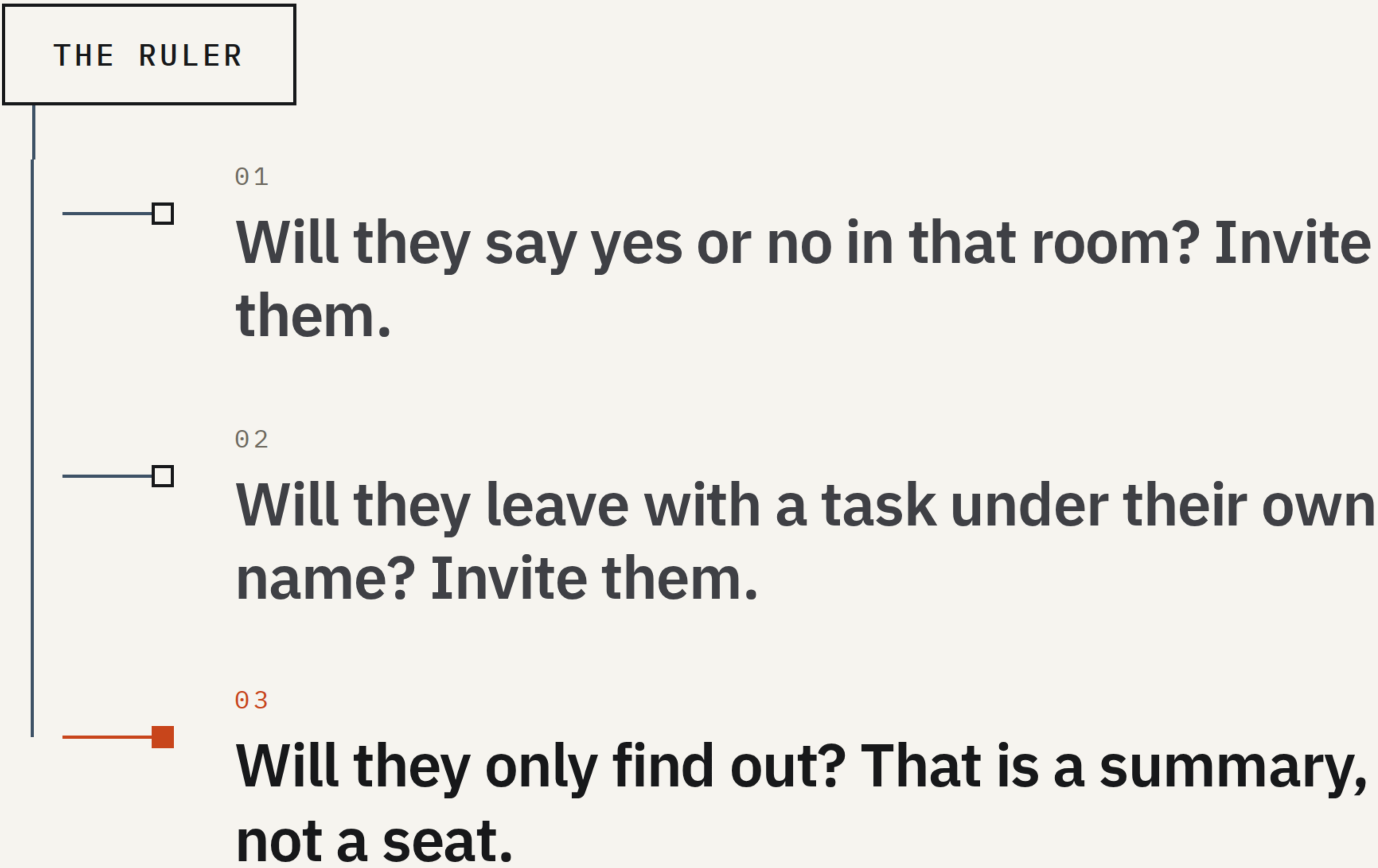
THE CONSEQUENCE

...and the room fills with people who listen, do not decide and leave with nothing to do.

The wrong person in a meeting is not neutral. They spend their own hour and dilute everyone else's.

THE FORK

Who has a seat in this meeting?



If a person can receive the decision in writing, they did not need to watch the decision.

THE METHOD

The Surgical Invite, four seats.



01 DECIDES

gives the yes or the no in the room, and answers for it afterwards

02 EXECUTES

leaves with the task under their name and the deadline in their calendar

03 KNOWS

holds the data nobody can decide without, comes in, answers and leaves

04 PAYS THE BILL

absorbs the consequence in their own area, needs to hear it before, not after

Whoever fits none of the four gets the summary. And the meeting loses nothing because of it.

WHAT TO SAY, IN ORDER

How to communicate the cut without walking on eggshells.

01 · DECIDES

This meeting exists to decide one thing, and I wrote it down.

the purpose comes before the list

02 · EXECUTES

The room keeps who decides, executes, holds the data or pays the bill.

public criterion, nobody is picked by taste

03 · KNOWS

Whoever is out gets the decision the same day, with owner and deadline.

out of the hour, never out of the loop

04 · PAYS THE
BILL

We are using everyone's time in the most effective way possible.

the answer to whoever complains, no apology

TWO MODELS

Crowded meeting or surgical meeting.

THE COMMON MODEL

The crowded meeting

Invites as a precaution, so nobody gets offended

Twelve in the room, three talk, nine wait

A detail that belonged to two becomes a debate for all

Ends with let's align again

THE DESIGNED MODEL

The surgical meeting

Invites by role, who decides, executes, knows or pays

Four in the room, four talk

A detail for two leaves the agenda and goes to the hallway

Ends with a decision, an owner and a deadline

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

What the wrong person costs.

01 Their hour.

- it was reserved for real work, and comes back at night as overtime.

02 Everyone else's hour.

- every extra guest opens a side conversation and stretches the agenda.

03 The decision.

- with more people opining without accountability, it slips to the next meeting.

Leaving a meeting feeling you wasted your time is not bad luck.
It is an invite someone did not have the courage not to send.

THE CHAIN

The open door test.

01

In the middle of the meeting, ask yourself silently: if I left right now, would any decision change?



02

If the answer is no, you should not have been invited. Elon Musk says get up and leave, and that the rude thing is making someone stay.



03

If the answer is yes, speak, decide or take the task. That is what the seat exists for.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Apply the test as a guest today and as a convener tomorrow. The list shrinks from both sides.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

Three moves before the next invite.

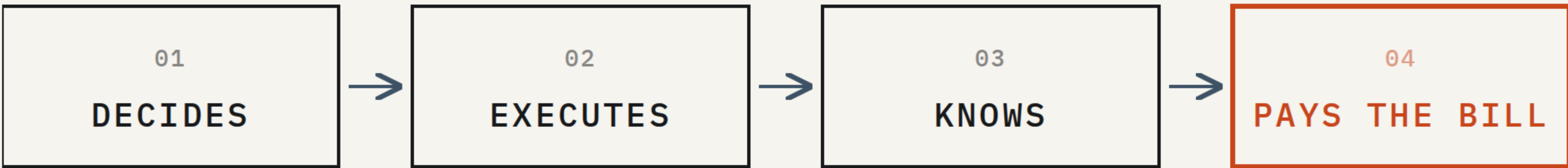
▣ STEP 01 Write the purpose in one sentence before opening the calendar. if the sentence does not come out, the invite does not go out	▣ STEP 02 Run every name through the four seats. decides, executes, knows or pays, whoever fits none gets the summary	■ STEP 03 Send the summary the same day to whoever was left out. it is what makes the cut acceptable, and what kills the complaint
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Start with the most crowded recurring meeting in your week. It is where the list lies the most.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Surgical Invite, in the order that matters.



A meeting is not a party. Every extra seat is an hour taken from someone.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER
before typing the next name into the invite.

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